

explains Sibal.

Qualcomm provides the technology and the chipset for OMH. "Qualcomm's QCS1010 chipsets support OMH," shares Anil Kaushik, vice president-executive, Fly Mobile. "Handsets using Qualcomm's OMH chipsets are basically OMH-compliant as these are capable of reading the network settings on the OMH SIM card," he adds.

"If you have a non-OMH SIM card based handset, you can change from one CDMA operator to the other," explains Vikas Jain, business director, Micromax. "But you will be able to access only the voice and SMS service of the operator. All the data applications will need manual configuration, which can be tedious at times," he adds. Also, the handsets are locked by the operators, which makes it difficult to switch between operators on the handset.

The OMH handsets are backward-compatible and can work with a non-OMH SIM card. Similarly, an OMH SIM can work with a non-open-market handset. You can slide in any operator's SIM in any handset and all the configuration settings for voice and data will be done automatically.

Three-fold benefits

OMH offers great benefits to all the main players in the CDMA ecosystem—the consumer, the OEMs for

the handsets and the operators.

"OMH has increased the choice of devices for the consumers with ease of access using OMH SIM cards. You can have great multimedia experience and leverage the Internet services on the high-speed data networks of CDMA operators," says Vrajesh Shelat, head of wireless data business, Reliance Communications. It has increased the touch points through retail distribu-

tion. As OMH offers operator-independent handsets and services across the globe, there is an increase in device volume. "Earlier, there was lack of multimedia and mid-range handsets (costing Rs 2500 to 9000) in the CDMA space. Larger device volumes across geographies will play a vital role in lowering the handset prices" shares Deval Parikh, chief officer of handsets, VAS and procurement, Virgin Mobile India.

Jain says, "OMH is one of the most exciting things to have happened to handset manufacturers. With OMH, we can have retail presence rather than the operator distributing the handsets." It has reduced the inventory risk, as one handset can be sold by many distribution channels.

"Operator need not worry about the inventory of the CDMA handsets," adds Parikh. So one major benefit of OMH to the operators is that it lowers the handset inventory cost.

OMH eliminates the operator-specific testing too. "For every operator, the OEM had to perform device test on the operator's network. As the handset becomes independent of the operator, it eliminates the testing related to the operator and increases time to market," says Jain. This re-



Micromax C350

duces the testing cost of the device at operators' end and also the consumer support cost.

Your pick

OMH will help fuel the growth and popularity of CDMA just like GSM. As mobile phones are more of a style statement today, consumers want to change them with fashion. OMH will provide them a great deal

of flexibility to switch their CDMA handsets and opt for high-end multimedia phones and smart phones.

"So far we have binary runtime environment for wireless (BREW) based OMH handsets. There are plans to launch Android-based handsets this year," shares Jain.

Just by sliding the OMH SIM card, all the network settings get activated automatically, unlike the lengthy process of calling the operator, getting the parameters, entering them manually and then finally using the data service.

OMH SIM cards and OMH handsets can be easily recognised by the trademarked OMH logo, as seen in a gem. "The OMH SIM card and the service will not carry any additional cost with it," shares Shelat.

Ajay Mathur, senior VP, Tata Teleservices, informs, "In a very short span of the commercial launch of OMH, we have seen 15-20 per cent growth from the open market initiative. This platform will give tremendous boost to usage of the Internet through high-end phones for rich data downloads in India."

It started off well, and holds a great potential. The consumers, operators and OEMs, all foresee a great market for OMH. ●

OMH operators in India

- Reliance Mobile
- Tata Indicom
- MTS
- Virgin Mobile India

Handsets available

- Samsung Mpower 699
- Samsung Mpower Muzik 219
- Samsung Corby Speed
- Samsung Duos 259
- Micromax C350
- SIM Technology's C24